

Point me at problems. I'll solve them, fixed price, fixed deliverables.

A partner brief for SAP account executives whose customers are running out of trial window before the demo lands on real data.

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Focus · SAP BW / BW/4HANA / AfO customers moving to Datasphere and SAC

Audience · SAP account executives (presales architecture)

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The one line

Point me at problems. I'll solve them, fixed price, fixed deliverables — the small, specific presales things you cannot get out of an SI or your own bench. The test is whether you send anything.

Who's on the other side of the offer

SCS Decision Intelligence Center of Excellence. A specialized bench inside Steel Cloud Solutions.

What it does, and only what it does: **take SAP content and make the projects more successful using AI tools — primarily Perplexity projects and private repositories, with human authorization on artifacts that carry consequence.**

Not a full SI. Not competing with your incumbent partners. Additive — not substitutive, not oppositional. A bench that operates in packaged, fixed-price, exit-friendly units, sitting inside an SAP account when — and only when — an AI-shaped presales problem is blocking a licensing conversation.

What "you cannot get otherwise" actually means

Three things existing options do not deliver in a bounded, fixed-price shape:

- 1. A working demo on the customer's own SAP data — not sample data — inside 3–4 weeks,** running against the customer's own Datasphere and SAC tenant (trial, subscribed, or an existing one). SIs cannot spin this up without a full statement of work; the AE's own bench does not have SAP-specific AI tooling; the customer's IT team does not have the room to build a real-data proof between other commitments.
- 2. A governed AI agent over Datasphere delivered inside Microsoft Teams,** on real customer data, with source citations. The [DMZ Open](#) surface — LangGraph agent API, Teams bot, LangFuse proxy, Azure Foundry / DeepSeek integration, OData / SAP Datasphere read path — is already running.
- 3. Every artifact in a private repository with cryptographic hashes and clickable canonical links.** Nothing walks out on a consultant's laptop, nothing lives only in a chat window. The customer keeps the repository at exit.

Those three, together, are the differentiation.

The customer situation the AE already knows

Applies to any SAP ECC, S/4, BW, BW/4HANA, or AfO customer looking at Datasphere and SAC — whether they are pre-trial, in-trial, post-trial, or already subscribed and stalled.

- **SAP ECC / Business Suite 7** — mainstream maintenance ends **31 December 2027**, optional extended maintenance runs to **31 December 2030** at a two-percentage-point uplift ([SAP · Maintenance Strategy](#)). Every ECC customer is having the successor conversation right now; the analytics side of that conversation is Datasphere + SAC.
- **Classic SAP BW 7.5** — mainstream maintenance ends 31 December 2027, extended maintenance ends 31 December 2030 ([SAP · BW/4HANA End of Mainstream Maintenance Key Dates](#); [SAP · NetWeaver 7.5 & BW/4HANA Maintenance Strategy](#)).
- **SAP BW/4HANA** — maintained through at least 2040. Not end-of-life, but innovation gravity has moved to Datasphere and SAP Analytics Cloud.
- **SAP Analysis for Microsoft Office (AfO)** — the Excel-on-BW front-end most customers actually live inside every day. Successor path: the SAC add-in for Microsoft 365.
- **Datasphere + SAC** — the sanctioned successor stack. A [30-day Datasphere free trial](#) and a [free SAC trial](#) exist for customers who want to sample first; existing Datasphere or SAC tenants work equally well as the runway.

The gap is not architecture and it is not licensing. It is presales execution capacity in bounded units, delivered against the customer's own data.

The reference — delivered work

Publicly visible in redacted form, in the legal-tech vertical:

- A Contract-to-Cash semantic layer in SAP Datasphere — governed, evidence-bound.
- A cross-system AI agent — LangGraph reasoning against real customer data with source citations and compliance controls.
- Delivery through Microsoft Teams — the users' existing interface.
- A public demonstration surface the customer's executives can open in a browser.
- A public reference model — governance-first Datasphere schema covering 58 tables across FI, CO, MM, SD, PP, and PM semantics.

Systems in scope for the reference: SAP S/4HANA, Workday, Salesforce, Bullhorn, AWS S3/Lake.

How the work actually gets done — the method

- **Perplexity projects** — each workstream lives in its own Perplexity project, with its own memory, sources, and threads.

- **Private repositories** — every artifact lands in a private repo with cryptographic hashes and clickable canonical links.
- **AI tools applied to SAP content** — schema reasoning, migration diffs, transport analysis, report parity checks, evidence packs. AI-authored, human-authorized. Speed from AI, accountability from the human sign-off canon around it.
- **Additive stance** — preserve what already works at the customer (their existing SI, their existing operating model, their existing BW where BW earns its keep) and introduce change only where it demonstrably improves the stated objective. The public [SAPfans.io](https://sapfans.io) commons is the same principle turned outward: preserve useful SAP knowledge, cite evidence, accept correction.

Four packaged small work units

Each is quotable in a sentence, deliverable in weeks, fixed-price, and exit-friendly. If it doesn't go further, SCS hands back the repository and leaves.

1 · Datasphere Demo-Tenant Setup on the Customer's Own Data

Stand up a governed Datasphere trial tenant against the customer's own SAP source. Materialize a bounded subset of ACDOCA (or equivalent) and publish two or three analytic models finance recognizes on sight. Not sample data. **3–4 weeks, fixed price.**

2 · AfO-to-SAC Report Parity Sprint

The five AfO reports finance opens every morning, reproduced in the SAC add-in for Microsoft 365 against the customer's Datasphere semantic layer, with a side-by-side reconciliation to the cent. **4–6 weeks, fixed price per report bundle.**

3 · Governed Finance Proof — the Delivered Shape, Repointed

The reference pattern — Datasphere as the semantic hub, LangGraph over governed OData, Teams as the delivery surface — bounded to one finance lane the customer chooses (revenue recognition, receivables aging, or intercompany reconciliation). **6–8 weeks, fixed price, exit-friendly.**

4 · BW Replacement Proof

A bounded proof that Datasphere + SAC can perform the reporting the current BW installation performs today — validated by the customer's own finance team, exceptions explicitly listed. **6–10 weeks, fixed price** with named finance-user validation.

The commercial shape

1. **The AE refers.** They send any ECC / BW / AfO customer where Datasphere + SAC is on the table — pre-purchase, mid-trial, post-trial, or already subscribed and stalled. An AfO base that will not migrate itself, a CFO who wants proof before authorizing a purchase order, an ECC customer

whose steering committee will not sign off on the successor stack without a working artifact — all of it qualifies.

2. **SCS executes on whatever tenant is in play.** A Datasphere trial, a subscribed Datasphere tenant, or a fresh trial spun up for the engagement — SCS uses what the customer already has. The AE does not procure infrastructure; the customer does not sign a large statement of work.
3. **The setup is packaged, fixed-price, and exit-friendly.** One of the four packages above.
4. **The AE closes the license.** The customer has seen Datasphere and SAC work on their data. They buy more.

Where SCS fits inside a full S/4 conversion

Full S/4HANA implementations belong with an SI. SCS has two roles when they come, both aligned to SAP license growth:

- **Flex labor supporting the incumbent SI** — named specialist capacity when the SI wants it. The SI retains the customer relationship and the implementation revenue.
- **An affordable alternative** — only if the customer has no incumbent and cannot fund a large SI, so demo momentum survives into the license close.

The deal the AE cares about is the SAP license. The Center of Excellence's role is to make sure the demo experience justifies that license, and to stay out of the way of the SI's implementation revenue.

References

- [DMZ Open — governed Teams / Datasphere agent surface](#)
- [SAPfans.io — additive public knowledge commons for the SAP ecosystem](#)
- [SAP · Maintenance Strategy \(ECC / Business Suite 7\)](#)
- [SAP · BW/4HANA End of Mainstream Maintenance Key Dates](#)
- [SAP · NetWeaver 7.5 & BW/4HANA maintenance strategy](#)
- [SAP Datasphere trial](#)
- [SAP Analytics Cloud trial](#)
- [Jeff Eden on LinkedIn](#)

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